STUDENT AFFAIRS
VIRGINIA TECH

Living-Learning Programs at Virginia Tech

Programs, Participation, and Cost Overview

WHAT ARE LIVING-LEARNING PROGRAMS?

Living-Learning Programs (LLPs) at Virginia Tech are residential communities where students live together around a shared academic interest or theme and participate in intentionally designed educational, co-curricular, and community-building experiences that connect what they learn in the classroom with where they live.

Our Community Types

4 Residential Colleges

HONORS RESIDENTIAL COMMONS
FOUNDED IN 2011
305 CURRENT STUDENTS

22 Living-Learning Communities

GALILEO
AN ENGINEERING LIVING-LEARNING COMMUNITY AT VIRGINIA TECH®

GALILEO LLC
FOUNDED IN 2005
358 CURRENT STUDENTS

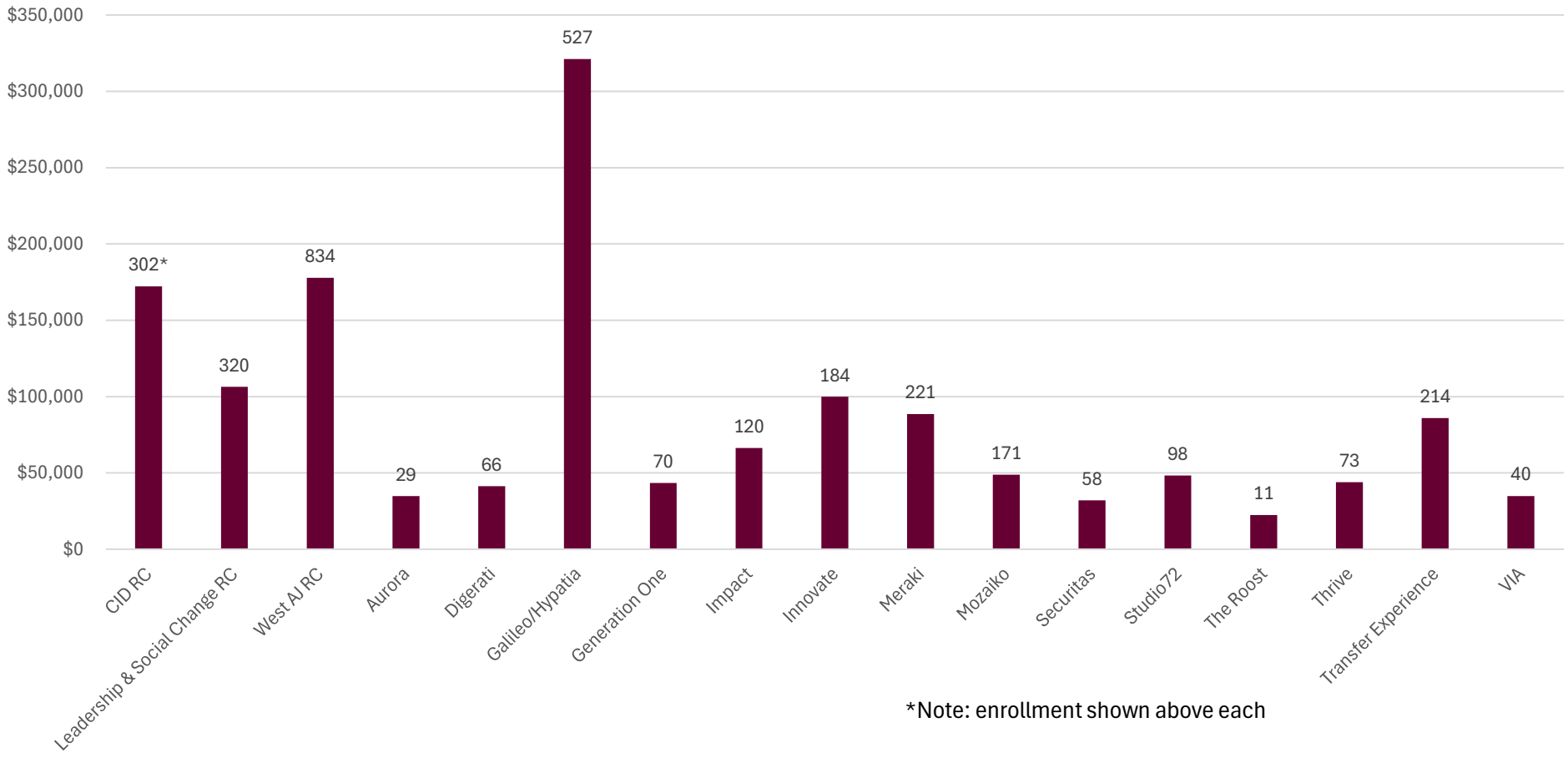
2026-2027 RESIDENTIAL COLLEGES

- Creativity and Innovation District
- Honors Residential Commons
- Residential College at West Ambler Johnston
- Leadership & Social Change Residential College

2026-2027 LIVING-LEARNING COMMUNITIES

- Aurora (Interfaith)
- Casa Maderni (International Scholarship)
- Convergence (Transdisciplinary Collaboration)
- Corps of Cadets
- Digerati (Emerging Technologies)
- Galileo & Hypatia (Engineering)
- GenerationOne (First-Gen Students)
- Hillcrest (Honors)
- Impact (Data Analytics)
- Innovate (Entrepreneurship)
- Meraki (Well-being)
- Mozaiko (Intercultural Competence & Leadership)
- The Roost (Supporting Recovery)
- Securitas (Cybersecurity)
- Studio 72 (Arts & Creativity)
- Thrive (Personal Growth)
- Transfer Experience (Transfer Students)
- VIA (Major Exploration)

COST & ENROLLMENT BY PROGRAM



*Note: enrollment shown above each

LIVING-LEARNING PROGRAMS BUDGET MODEL

2025-2026 Participants totaling 3,338 excluding Corps of Cadets, Casa Maderni & Honors College programs

Total cost: $1.46M

- Expenses include program personnel and most are fractional share of an employee role (e.g., 10-50% LLP), reflecting shared responsibility
- Also included is the annual charge of $100 for participating students
  - Charge covers direct student programming only (events, speakers, retreats, experiential learning)

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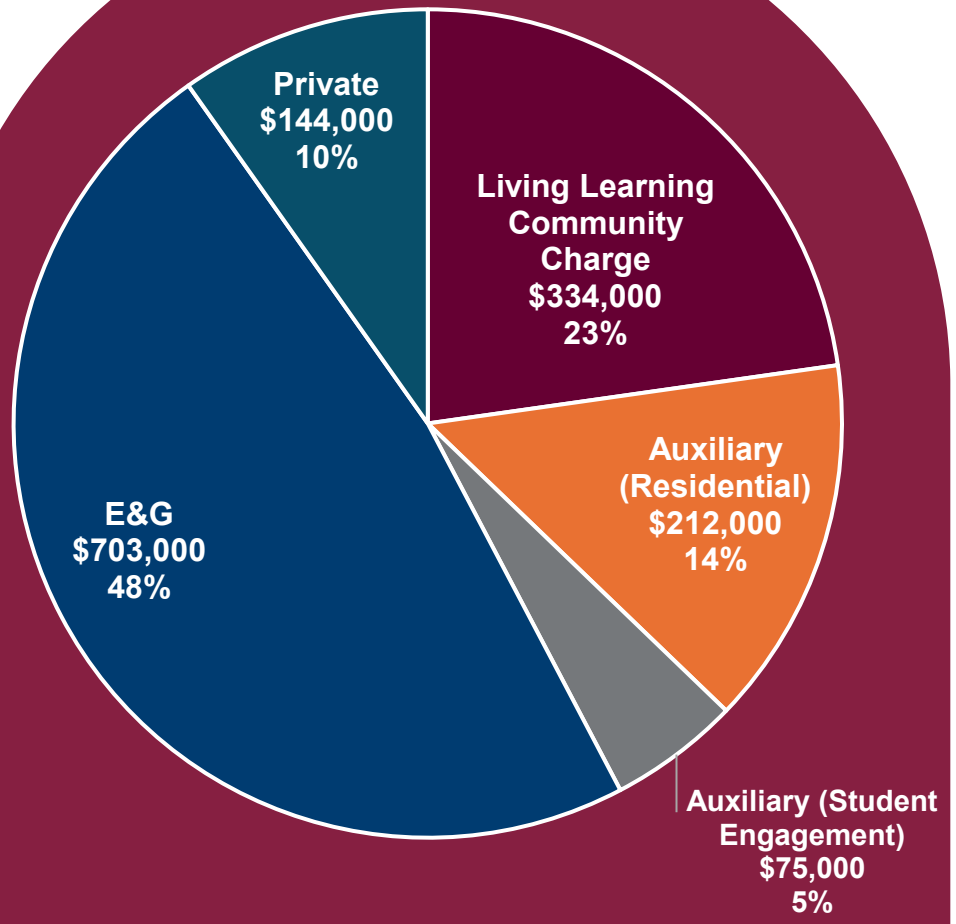
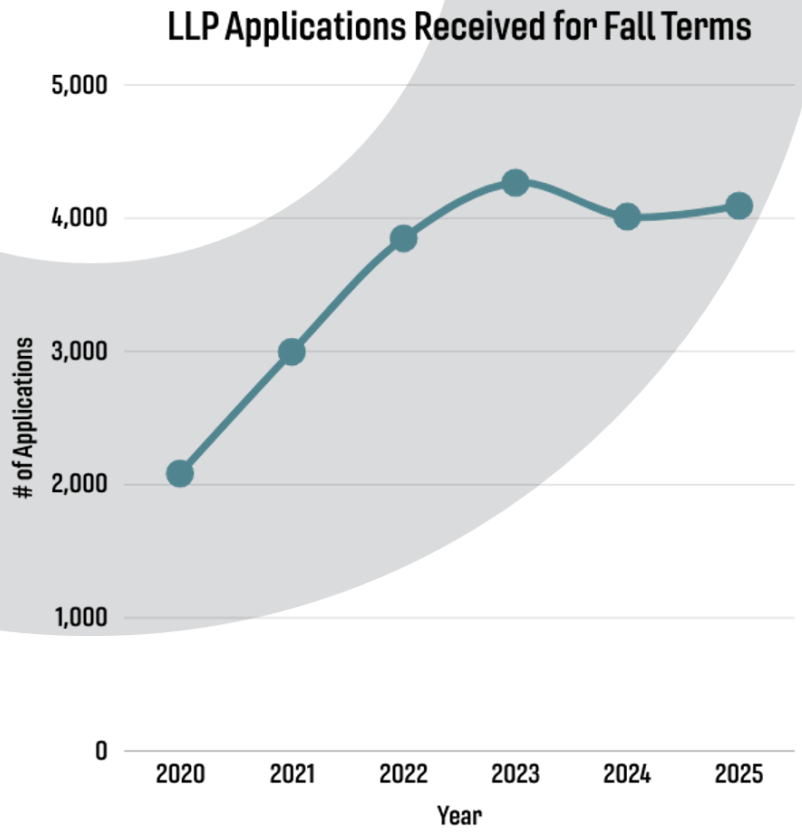


COST SUMMARY OF LIVING-LEARNING PROGRAMS AND RESIDENTIAL COLLEGES BY FUND SOURCE AY 26-27

- Broad Funding Support Including:
  - Auxiliary
  - E&G across several colleges
  - Private Support

INCREASED DEMAND FOR LIVING-LEARNING PROGRAMS BY INCOMING STUDENTS



- **Families use U.S. News rankings** as a signal of institutional quality when comparing colleges. **Virginia Tech ranks #22 nationally** for Living-Learning Programs (2025–2026)
- Application deadline for Fall 2026 is June 5.
- Current Applications (4/1/26): 897
  Accepted offers (4/1/26): 312
- Corps of Cadets, Casa Maderni, and Honors college applications are not included.

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OUR KEY COMPETITORS OFFER LIVING-LEARNING PROGRAMS

Top In-State Competitor

University of Virginia

Top Out-of-State Competitors

Purdue University

PennState

University of Maryland

The University of Tennessee Knoxville

Clemson

University of Michigan

NC State University

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Georgia Institute of Technology

University of South Carolina

The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

OUR KEY COMPETITORS OFFER LIVING-LEARNING PROGRAMS

Peer Group	Institutions with Living Learning Communities/Residential Colleges
Competing Institutions	22 of 27
SCHEV Peer Institutions	24 of 25
US-based Public AAU Institutions	37 of 38
Virginia Public Institutions	13 of 15
Institutions in 3 or more categories	7 of 7

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RESOLUTION ON THE IMPACT OF THE LIVING-LEARNING PROGRAM

ON THE

AFFORDABILITY OF HIGHER EDUCATION AT VIRGINIA TECH

WHEREAS, Governor Spanberger maintains a strong commitment to Virginia institutions of higher education offering affordable educational opportunities to all Virginians; and, President Tim Sands in his 2026 State of the University Address reiterated the commitment of Virginia Tech to increasing the availability of quality affordable on-campus living opportunities for our undergraduate student population; and,

WHEREAS, the Joint Legislative Audit and Review Commission (JLARC) October 2024 *Spending and Efficiency in Higher Education* report to the Governor and the General Assembly of Virginia review of public four-year higher education institutions addressed the cost of attendance, institutional revenue, and institutional spending and stated the importance of monitoring student costs and identified opportunities to reduce student cost; and,

WHEREAS, the State Council of Higher Education for Virginia (SCHEV) recognizes the role of the boards of visitors of Virginia higher education institutions in the effective stewardship of university resources and managing those resources in a manner that addresses affordability by evaluating duplication of services and identifying efficiencies to reduce costs; and,

WHEREAS, the Board of Visitors actively undertakes its role of monitoring the affordability of attending Virginia Tech and conducts ongoing efforts to make certain the university is efficiently deploying university resources to lower student costs; and,

WHEREAS, providing a quality on-campus housing experience for first-year undergraduate students, including first-year transfer students, remains a primary mission of the university as it is recognized campus living opportunities aid first-year students in the transition to the university community, enhance student success possibilities and increase the likelihood of academic success; and,

WHEREAS, in 2009, Virginia Tech formalized the concept of a residential college model to create faculty-led engagements directly into the residential hall living environment; and, in 2021, the University formally established the Office of Living-Learning Programs; and,

WHEREAS, after creating the Living-Learning Program, Virginia Tech designated the existing Corps of Cadets residential facilities as a Living-Learning Community and, recognizing that since the 1990s Virginia Tech has offered an on-campus residential living option for participants in the Virginia Tech Honors College, and designated Hillcrest Honors and the Honors Residential Commons each as a Living-Learning Community; and,

WHEREAS, in addition to the Corps of Cadets and residential Honors College housing, Virginia Tech has identified [20] additional Living-Learning Communities; and,

WHEREAS, today the University dedicates financial and staffing resources from multiple areas within the University to support and grow the Living-Learning Program, allocates significant staff and faculty resources some of whom may devote up to 100% of their time commitment in non-classroom teaching; and reserves residential hall bed space for faculty, staff, and participating upper-class students making these residential hall spaces no longer available for first-year undergraduate students or first-year transfer students; and,

WHEREAS, the Virginia Tech Residential Well-Being Program (formerly known as Resident Assistants) serves all residential students, and those students participating in Living-Learning Programs receive staff support from both staff in the Virginia Tech Residential Well Being Program and staff of the Living-Learning Program; and,

WHEREAS, the Two Hundred Fifty-Five student leaders participating in the Residential Well- Being Program receive a significant compensation package ranging between $12,546 to $12,769 per semester, which is in addition to the resources provided to the Living-Learning Program; and,

WHEREAS, recognizing that the State Council of Higher Education has directed boards of visitors to use common data metrics to govern effectively; and, given the significant investment of university resources, the Board of Visitors must address the Living-Learning Program because data-driven metrics do not support a measurable difference in either the academic outcomes for students in Living-Learning Programs compared to the overall student population (3.22 GPA in Living-Learning Communities compared to a 3.19 GPA all first-year average) or the retention of students (with a fall-to-fall retention rate in Living-Learning Communities of 92.4% vs a fall-to-fall first-year student retention rate of 91.8%); and,

WHEREAS, the Board of Visitors believes that it is in the best interests of the university to reallocate all available on-campus residential hall beds to first-year undergraduate students and first-year transfer students and that the elimination of the Living-Learning Program will produce a significant number of available beds for these students while also generating significant cost savings for the university; and,

WHEREAS, Virginia Tech provides all students with a vast array of support services and the Living-Learning Program structure generates a significant duplication of many such services and while the Board of Visitors recognizes that the Living-Learning Program engages students to form communities of common interest, the Board of Visitors encourages all Virginia Tech students to form clubs based on shared interest and goals;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, that, effective immediately, the Virginia Tech Corps of Cadets, the Virginia Tech residential programs for the Virginia Tech Honors College, and the Casa Maderni program in Switzerland are hereby removed from the Living-Learning Program; and, be it,

FURTHER RESOLVED, that the efficacy of the Living-Learning Communities program will be evaluated based on data driven metrics by the Board of Visitors and the Office of the Executive Vice President and Provost in cooperation with the Office of Student Affairs and all residential hall beds currently reserved for non-freshman undergraduate students and

non-first-year transfer students will be made available for freshman undergraduate students and first-year transfer students beginning with the fall of 2027; and, that the combined savings from the changes to these programs will generate significant savings to the University, taxpayers of Virginia, and our students without sacrificing services available through above-noted programs open to all students by eliminating duplication of services and increasing efficiency.

RECOMMENDATION:

That the above resolution be approved.

April 14, 2026